SkillNavora Academy · Master Freelancing

Freelance Business and Agency Development

Marketplaces, proposals, pricing, contracts, payments, clients, agency growth and a prompt library

Companion to the seven skill departments · Draft · Official site: www.skillnavora.in

Fees, rules, tax and law change and differ by country. This is not legal, tax or financial advice. Official links were not checked live in this draft.

Contents

1. How to use this textbook
2. Are you ready? Choosing a niche and an offer
3. Marketplaces compared
4. Profile, portfolio, proposals and outreach
5. Pricing and quotes
6. Contracts, scope and change requests
7. Invoicing, payments and tax basics
8. Working with clients
9. Agency development
10. Jobs, part-time work and internships
11. 30, 60, 90 and 180-day roadmap
12. Prompt library (104 starters)
13. Assessment rubrics and certificate wording
14. Glossary of freelance business terms

START HERE

How to use this textbook

This book turns skills from the seven departments into a freelance business: finding clients, pricing, contracts, payments, and growing towards an agency.

Where this book fits

Department	Skill textbook
1	Development and IT
2	AI and Automation
3	Design and Creative
4	Marketing
5	Data Analytics and Data Science
6	Admin and Business Support
7	Writing and Content

Pick one skill from a department, build the portfolio project from its chapter, then use this book to sell it.

VERIFICATION NOTE

Marketplace fees, rules, tax rates and legal requirements change and differ by country. This book gives frameworks and checklists, not legal, tax or financial advice. Official links were not checked live in this draft; confirm every figure on the official site or with a qualified professional. All prices in examples are illustrative.

PART 1 · MODULE A

Are you ready? Choosing a niche and an offer

Narrow offers are easier to sell than broad ones.

A1. Readiness check

- I can deliver one service end to end.
- I have at least one portfolio project with a before-and-after.
- I can reply to clients within one working day.
- I understand the basic tax and registration rules where I live (check official sources).

A2. Offer formula

I help [specific customer] get [specific result] with [your service], delivered in [time].

Example: I help small shops get clean monthly books, delivered by the 5th.

A3. Three offers

Offer	Scope	Why
Starter	One small deliverable	Low risk first project
Standard	Full service, set revisions	Your main offer
Retainer	Monthly hours or tasks	Steady work

PART 1 · MODULE B

Marketplaces compared

Where freelancers find clients, and how to choose.

Platform	Model	Official site (not checked live)
Upwork	Project and hourly marketplace	www.upwork.com
Fiverr	Packaged services (gigs)	www.fiverr.com
Freelancer	Contests and projects	www.freelancer.com
Toptal	Screened talent network	www.toptal.com
PeoplePerHour	Hourly and fixed offers	www.peopleperhour.com
Contra	Portfolio and projects	contra.com
LinkedIn Services	Services listing	www.linkedin.com
Internshala	Internships and entry jobs (India)	internshala.com
Truelancer	Freelance marketplace (India)	www.truelancer.com

B1. Before you join any platform

- Read the current fee page and terms on the official site.
- Note how payments, withdrawals and currency conversion work.
- Keep communication and payment on the platform where its terms require it.
- Never pay to receive work; ignore offers that ask for a fee, a deposit or bank details before a contract.

SCAM SIGNS

A fake cheque you are asked to deposit, a 'training fee', a request to move to a private chat before the contract, an unrealistic pay offer for simple work, or a link that asks you to log in on a look-alike page.

VERIFICATION NOTE

Marketplace fees, rules, tax rates and legal requirements change and differ by country. This book gives frameworks and checklists, not legal, tax or financial advice. Official links were not checked live in this draft; confirm every figure on the official site or with a qualified professional. All prices in examples are illustrative.

PART 1 · MODULE C

Profile, portfolio, proposals and outreach

How to be found and how to reply.

C1. Profile checklist

- Headline with your offer, not your job title.
- First two lines state who you help and the result.
- Three portfolio items with problem, action, result.
- Clear process and delivery time.
- Honest reviews and testimonials only.

C2. Portfolio case study format

Problem, what you did, tools, result (use a real number or say 'practice project'), and a link to the work.

C3. Proposal template

TEXT

```
Hello [Name],

I read your brief about [project]. The main goal seems to be [goal].

How I would do it:
1. [Step one]
2. [Step two]
3. [Step three]

Similar work: [link to one relevant sample].
Time: [days]. Price: [amount] for [scope], including [number] revisions.

Two questions so I can start well:
- [Question one]
- [Question two]

Thank you,
[Your name]
```

C4. Cold outreach template

TEXT

```
Subject: A quick idea for [business]

Hi [Name],

I noticed [specific observation about their business].
I help [type of business] with [result]. For example, [one short proof].

Would a short plan for [business] be useful? I can send it this week.

[Your name]
```

OUTREACH RULES

Follow the email and messaging consent rules where you and the recipient live. Send to businesses with a relevant need, be honest, give an easy way to opt out, and never send bulk unsolicited messages.

PART 1 · MODULE D

Pricing and quotes

Price from your costs and the client's result, not from guesses.

D1. Illustrative pricing methods

Method	When it fits	Risk
Hourly	Unclear scope	Rewards slowness; clients cap hours
Fixed project	Clear scope	Scope creep
Retainer	Ongoing work	Hours not used or exceeded
Value-based	Clear business result	Needs proof of value

All figures below are illustrative examples, not market rates.

D2. Rate and quote calculator (tested)

PYTHON

```
def hourly_rate(monthly_income_goal, monthly_expenses, billable_hours, buffer_pct=15):
    """Illustrative: rate needed to reach a goal after expenses, with a buffer for unpaid gaps."""
    need = (monthly_income_goal + monthly_expenses) * (1 + buffer_pct / 100)
    return round(need / billable_hours, 2)

def project_quote(hours, rate, revisions_included=2, revision_hours=1.5, extra_revisions=0,
risk_pct=10):
    base = hours * rate
    risk = base * risk_pct / 100
    extra = extra_revisions * revision_hours * rate
    return {"base": round(base, 2), "risk_buffer": round(risk, 2), "extra_revisions": round(extra,
2), "total": round(base + risk + extra, 2)}

def deposit_schedule(total, deposit_pct=50):
    dep = round(total * deposit_pct / 100, 2)
    return {"deposit": dep, "balance": round(total - dep, 2)}

def proposal_win_rate(sent, interviews, hired):
    return {"reply_rate_pct": round(100 * interviews / sent, 1) if sent else 0.0,
"close_rate_pct": round(100 * hired / interviews, 1) if interviews else 0.0, "overall_pct":
round(100 * hired / sent, 1) if sent else 0.0}

print(hourly_rate(40000, 10000, 80, 15))
q = project_quote(10, 700, extra_revisions=2)
print(q)
print(deposit_schedule(q['total']))
print(proposal_win_rate(40, 8, 2))
assert hourly_rate(40000, 10000, 80, 15) == 718.75
assert q['total'] == 9800.0
print('pricing tests passed')
```

Reading the example. To earn 40,000 a month after 10,000 of costs, with 80 billable hours and a 15% buffer, the illustrative hourly rate is 718.75. A 10-hour job at 700 with two extra revisions totals 9,800 including a 10% risk buffer. A 50% deposit is 4,900. Of 40 proposals, 8 became interviews and 2 were hired: reply rate 20%, close rate 25%, overall 5%.

VERIFICATION NOTE

Marketplace fees, rules, tax rates and legal requirements change and differ by country. This book gives frameworks and checklists, not legal, tax or financial advice. Official links were not checked live in this draft; confirm every figure on the official site or with a qualified professional. All prices in examples are illustrative.

PART 1 · MODULE E

Contracts, scope and change requests

Write down what was agreed.

E1. What a freelance contract should cover

- Parties and contact details.
- Scope, deliverables and what is excluded.
- Price, deposit, milestones and payment dates.
- Revisions included and cost of extra ones.
- Timeline and what the client must provide.
- Ownership of the work and when it transfers (usually on full payment).
- Confidentiality.
- Termination and kill fee.
- Late payment terms.
- Governing law and how disputes are handled.

NOT LEGAL ADVICE

Use a contract template reviewed by a qualified lawyer in your country, or the platform's own terms. This list is a checklist for what to ask about, not a contract.

E2. Scope-change rule

Anything outside the written scope gets a short written change request with price and time before work starts.

PART 1 · MODULE F

Invoicing, payments and tax basics

Money rules vary; always verify officially.

F1. Getting paid

- Invoice with number, date, description, amount, due date and payment details.
- Take a deposit before starting.
- Use the marketplace's payment system where its terms require it.
- For international clients, check the bank or payment service's fees and conversion rate.

F2. Records

Keep invoices, contracts, receipts and bank statements in one folder per year.

F3. Tax and registration (check officially)

Freelancers usually must report income and may need registration depending on turnover and the services sold. Rules differ by country and change. For India, start with the official portals and a qualified chartered accountant:

- incometax.gov.in
- gst.gov.in
- rbi.org.in (foreign exchange rules)

IMPORTANT

This book does not state tax rates, thresholds or filing rules. Confirm them on the official portals or with a qualified professional.

PART 1 · MODULE G

Working with clients

Clear habits prevent most disputes.

G1. Client communication

- Confirm the brief in writing.
- Send a short update at agreed times.
- Raise problems early with a proposed fix.
- Ask for feedback against the brief, not opinions.

G2. Difficult situations

Situation	Response
Scope grows	Send a change request.
Late payment	Polite reminder, then the late-payment clause, then pause work.
Unclear feedback	Ask for examples of what is wanted.
Client disappears	Send a final notice with the deadline and stop.

PART 1 · MODULE H

Agency development

Scaling with process and quality control.

H1. From freelancer to agency

1. Stage 1: solo, one service, 3–5 repeat clients.
2. Stage 2: add a subcontractor for overflow; write simple processes.
3. Stage 3: productised services with fixed scopes and prices.
4. Stage 4: small team, a project manager role, and quality checks.

H2. Subcontracting checklist

- Written agreement with scope, price, ownership and confidentiality.
- Quality check before anything reaches the client.
- Client told, where their contract requires it.

H3. Agency service menu example

Package	Includes
Launch	Website, logo, first content
Growth	Marketing plan and monthly reporting
Support	Admin, bookkeeping and customer support hours

PART 1 · MODULE I

Jobs, part-time work and internships

A job and freelancing can run together.

I1. Jobs instead of (or alongside) freelancing

- Remote job boards and company career pages (check each site's own listing).
- Part-time and contract roles for building a track record.
- Internships for early experience.

Use the SkillNavora Job board for roles and the Writing and Content textbook for resume help. Never pay a fee to apply for a job.

PART 1 · MODULE J

30, 60, 90 and 180-day roadmap

A simple plan with evidence at each step.

J1. Roadmaps

Period	Goal	Evidence
Days 1–30	Pick a skill; finish one portfolio project	Project with before-and-after
Days 31–60	Profile, three samples, 20 proposals or outreach messages	Proposal log with replies
Days 61–90	First paid project; collect feedback	Invoice and testimonial
Days 91–180	Repeat clients; raise prices; add one service	Two repeat clients; updated rates

Results are not guaranteed; the plan shows effort to track.

PART 2 · PROMPT LIBRARY

Prompt library (104 starters)

Starter prompts across all seven departments plus the freelance business.

Replace [brackets] with real details. Never paste confidential client information into a tool the client has not approved, and always check the output.

#	Area	Prompt starter
1	Development and IT	Explain this error in plain words and list three likely causes: [paste text or details].
2	Development and IT	Write unit tests for this function: [paste text or details].
3	Development and IT	Review this code for security issues: [paste text or details].
4	Development and IT	Convert this function to another language: [paste text or details].
5	Development and IT	Write a README for this project: [paste text or details].
6	Development and IT	Suggest a database schema for this app: [paste text or details].
7	Development and IT	Explain this SQL query line by line: [paste text or details].
8	Development and IT	Write a regular expression for this pattern: [paste text or details].
9	Development and IT	Refactor this code to remove duplication: [paste text or details].
10	Development and IT	Create a checklist to launch this website: [paste text or details].
11	Development and IT	Write a bug report from these notes: [paste text or details].
12	Development and IT	Suggest an API design for this feature: [paste text or details].
13	Development and IT	Plan a safe database migration: [paste text or details].
14	AI and Automation	Draft a system prompt for a support chatbot: [paste text or details].
15	AI and Automation	List edge cases for this automation: [paste text or details].
16	AI and Automation	Design an n8n flow for this process: [paste text or details].
17	AI and Automation	Write a prompt that extracts fields from invoices as JSON: [paste text or details].
18	AI and Automation	Create test questions for this chatbot: [paste text or details].
19	AI and Automation	Summarise this document in five bullets with sources: [paste text or details].
20	AI and Automation	Suggest evaluation criteria for this AI feature: [paste text or details].
21	AI and Automation	Explain the risks of this AI workflow: [paste text or details].
22	AI and Automation	Write a human-review step for this automation: [paste text or details].
23	AI and Automation	Estimate the monthly cost of this AI feature: [paste text or details].
24	AI and Automation	Write a retrieval test set for this knowledge base: [paste text or details].
25	AI and Automation	Draft an acceptable-use note for this AI tool: [paste text or details].
26	AI and Automation	Compare two models for this task on cost and accuracy: [paste text or details].
27	Design and Creative	Give three logo concept descriptions for this brand: [paste text or details].
28	Design and Creative	Write a design brief questionnaire: [paste text or details].

29	Design and Creative	Critique this layout for hierarchy and contrast: [paste text or details].
30	Design and Creative	Suggest a colour palette and check contrast: [paste text or details].
31	Design and Creative	Write alt text for this image: [paste text or details].
32	Design and Creative	Create a storyboard outline for a 30-second ad: [paste text or details].
33	Design and Creative	Suggest a style guide structure: [paste text or details].
34	Design and Creative	Write a handoff note for developers: [paste text or details].
35	Design and Creative	List accessibility checks for this screen: [paste text or details].
36	Design and Creative	Plan a design review meeting: [paste text or details].
37	Design and Creative	Write a usability test script: [paste text or details].
38	Design and Creative	Suggest empty-state messages for this app: [paste text or details].
39	Design and Creative	Create a component naming guide: [paste text or details].
40	Marketing	Write five ad headlines for this offer: [paste text or details].
41	Marketing	Create a 30-day content calendar: [paste text or details].
42	Marketing	Draft a three-email welcome sequence: [paste text or details].
43	Marketing	Suggest keywords and questions for this topic: [paste text or details].
44	Marketing	Write a landing page outline: [paste text or details].
45	Marketing	Create an A/B test plan: [paste text or details].
46	Marketing	Draft a monthly report summary from these numbers: [paste text or details].
47	Marketing	Write a local business profile description: [paste text or details].
48	Marketing	Suggest influencer outreach criteria: [paste text or details].
49	Marketing	List tracking events for this funnel: [paste text or details].
50	Marketing	Draft a competitor comparison table to verify: [paste text or details].
51	Marketing	Write a webinar follow-up email: [paste text or details].
52	Marketing	Suggest a content repurposing plan: [paste text or details].
53	Data Analytics	Explain what this chart shows: [paste text or details].
54	Data Analytics	Write a SQL query for monthly revenue: [paste text or details].
55	Data Analytics	Suggest checks for data quality: [paste text or details].
56	Data Analytics	Write steps to clean this dataset: [paste text or details].
57	Data Analytics	Suggest KPIs for this business: [paste text or details].
58	Data Analytics	Draft a summary of this analysis for a manager: [paste text or details].
59	Data Analytics	Explain this DAX measure: [paste text or details].
60	Data Analytics	Suggest a dashboard layout for this audience: [paste text or details].
61	Data Analytics	Write a pandas snippet to group and total: [paste text or details].
62	Data Analytics	List assumptions behind this forecast: [paste text or details].

63	Data Analytics	Write a data dictionary for this table: [paste text or details].
64	Data Analytics	Suggest a chart type for this question: [paste text or details].
65	Data Analytics	Draft a one-page analysis brief: [paste text or details].
66	Admin and Support	Draft a polite follow-up email: [paste text or details].
67	Admin and Support	Write inbox triage rules: [paste text or details].
68	Admin and Support	Create a meeting agenda and notes template: [paste text or details].
69	Admin and Support	Draft a reply to an upset customer: [paste text or details].
70	Admin and Support	Write a reconciliation checklist: [paste text or details].
71	Admin and Support	Create an onboarding checklist for a new client: [paste text or details].
72	Admin and Support	Write an escalation note: [paste text or details].
73	Admin and Support	Build a weekly status report outline: [paste text or details].
74	Admin and Support	Create standard operating steps for this task: [paste text or details].
75	Admin and Support	Write a cold-call opening that respects consent: [paste text or details].
76	Admin and Support	Draft a returns policy summary for customers: [paste text or details].
77	Admin and Support	Create a risk log from this project plan: [paste text or details].
78	Admin and Support	Write a handover note for a colleague: [paste text or details].
79	Writing and Content	Create an outline for this article: [paste text or details].
80	Writing and Content	Rewrite this paragraph at a plainer level: [paste text or details].
81	Writing and Content	Cut this text by 30 percent: [paste text or details].
82	Writing and Content	List every factual claim in this text: [paste text or details].
83	Writing and Content	Write three subject lines: [paste text or details].
84	Writing and Content	Rewrite this resume bullet with an action and a result I provide: [paste text or details].
85	Writing and Content	Draft a case study structure: [paste text or details].
86	Writing and Content	Write microcopy for this error message: [paste text or details].
87	Writing and Content	Create a style sheet from these examples: [paste text or details].
88	Writing and Content	Suggest headings that answer search questions: [paste text or details].
89	Writing and Content	Write a newsletter issue outline: [paste text or details].
90	Writing and Content	Draft a LinkedIn post from these facts I confirm: [paste text or details].
91	Writing and Content	Create a fact-check log from this draft: [paste text or details].
92	Freelance business	Draft a proposal from this brief: [paste text or details].
93	Freelance business	Write three questions to ask a new client: [paste text or details].
94	Freelance business	Write a polite late-payment reminder: [paste text or details].
95	Freelance business	Draft a scope-change request: [paste text or details].
96	Freelance business	Suggest packages for this service: [paste text or details].

97	Freelance business	Write a project kickoff email: [paste text or details].
98	Freelance business	Summarise a client call into actions: [paste text or details].
99	Freelance business	Draft a testimonial request: [paste text or details].
100	Freelance business	Write a short 'about me' for a profile: [paste text or details].
101	Freelance business	List risks in this project plan: [paste text or details].
102	Freelance business	Write a rate-increase email to a client: [paste text or details].
103	Freelance business	Draft a project close-out summary: [paste text or details].
104	Freelance business	Write a polite way to decline a project: [paste text or details].

PART 2 · ASSESSMENT

Assessment rubrics and certificate wording

Honest evidence of learning.

K1. Portfolio project rubric (20 points)

Criterion	0	2	4
Brief and goal clear	Missing	Partly	Clear
Method explained	Missing	Partly	Clear steps
Result or evidence	None	Partial	Measured or tested
Quality of work	Poor	Fair	Client-ready
Presentation	Hard to follow	Fair	Clear and honest

16–20: client-ready. 10–15: revise. Under 10: redo.

K2. Internal certificate wording

CERTIFICATE OF COMPLETION (INTERNAL)

This certificate shows that the holder completed the SkillNavora Master Freelancing practice projects for [department]. It is an internal certificate of completion. It is not a government, university or industry-accredited qualification and does not guarantee employment or income.

PART 2 · GLOSSARY

Glossary of freelance business terms

Short plain definitions.

Term	Meaning
A/B test	Comparing two versions to see which performs better.
Applicant tracking system	Software employers use to filter resumes.
Billable hours	Hours you can charge a client for.
Buffer	Extra time or money allowed for the unexpected.
Case study	A story of one project with approved facts.
Change request	A written, priced request to add or change scope.
Deliverable	A specific item handed to the client.
Deposit	Part of the price paid before work starts.
Invoice	A bill with number, date, amount and due date.
KPI	A number used to track progress towards a goal.
Kill fee	A payment owed if the client ends the project early.
Milestone	A checkpoint tied to a deliverable and a payment.
NDA	Non-disclosure agreement about confidential information.
Net 30	Payment due 30 days after the invoice date.
Niche	A narrow group of customers or a narrow service.
Outreach	Contacting a prospect who has not asked to hear from you.
Portfolio	Evidence of your work with problem, action and result.
Productised service	A service sold as a fixed package with a fixed price.
Proposal	A message that offers to do the work and explains how.
Retainer	A recurring monthly arrangement for agreed work or hours.
Revision	A round of changes to a deliverable.
SOP	Standard operating procedure: written steps for a task.
Scope	What work is and is not included in a project.
Scope creep	Work growing beyond the written scope.
Subcontractor	Someone you hire to do part of a client's work.